2008 Honda Civic LX

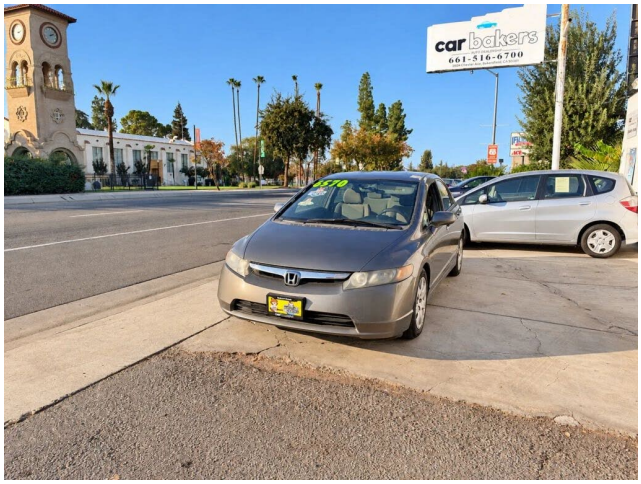
$6,570 · 120,126 miles · Dealer · Bakersfield, CA

Seller: Car Bakers

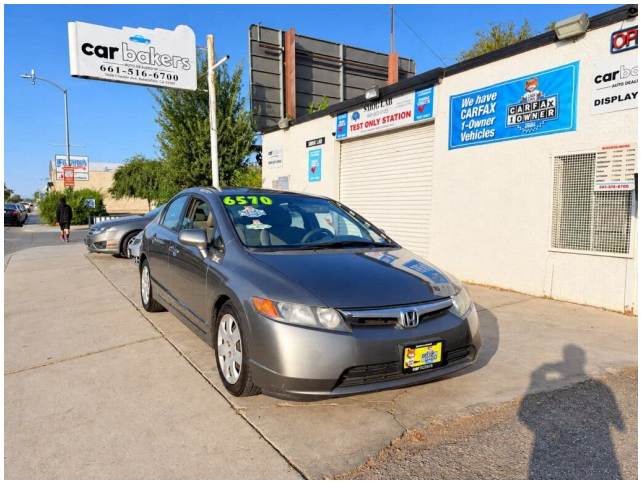
Source: CarGurus

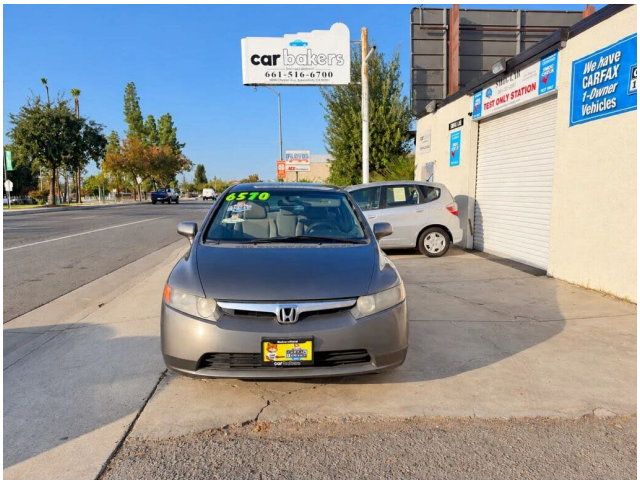
Listing: https://www.cargurus.com/details/462728532

Report generated November 04, 2026 · Ridgecrest Car Finder









+ 8 more photos in the app.

Out-the-door price	Monthly cost to own	Reliability
$7,533	**$496**	**Average**
Set a budget in the Cost Calculator tab to compare.	loan + insurance + fuel + repairs + registration	3/5 · 7 recalls · 916 NHTSA complaints

Budget — buying it

Vehicle price	$6,570.00
Sales tax (9.25%)	$607.73
Dealer doc + filing fees	$125.00
Vehicle license fee (0.65% of price)	$42.70
Registration + CHP fee	$108.00
Transportation improvement fee	$65.00
Title transfer	$15.00
Total out-the-door	$7,533.43
+ Pre-purchase inspection (you pay the shop)	$150.00

California taxes the full price — a trade-in does not reduce sales tax. DMV fees are estimates; the CA DMV fee calculator gives exact amounts.

Budget — paying for it

Down payment	$5,000.00
Amount financed	$2,533.43
Monthly loan payment (60 mo @ 7.5% APR)	$50.76
Total interest over the loan	$512.45
Cash needed up front (down payment + inspection)	$5,150.00

Budget — owning it each month

Loan payment	$50.76
Insurance (estimate, full)	$135.00
Fuel (1,000 mi/mo @ 29 MPG, $4.75/gal)	$163.79
Maintenance & repair reserve	$130.00
Registration renewal (÷12)	$16.06
Total per month	$495.62

Running costs without the loan: **$445/mo**. Estimated first-year cost of ownership: **$13,197** (out-the-door + inspection + 12 months of running costs + loan interest).

The repair reserve is set from the reliability rating and mileage: money to set aside, not a forecast.

Insurance

Coverage	Typical Ridgecrest range	Estimate used
Liability only (CA minimum 30/60/15)	$49–$112/mo	$70/mo
Full coverage (liability + collision + comprehensive)	$94–$243/mo	$135/mo

The budget above uses the **full coverage** estimate ($135/mo). Get real quotes and enter one in the app to replace it.

• Vehicle class: common sedan/hatch. Estimates assume an adult driver with a clean record; age, record, credit, and coverage limits change the price a lot.

• Ridgecrest is one of the cheapest places in California to insure a car (about $107–110/mo average).

• A lender will require full coverage. On an older, cheap car paid in cash, liability-only can make sense — but you'd pay for your own repairs after an at-fault accident.

• California's minimum (30/60/15) is low; $100k/$300k/$100k liability is commonly recommended.

• Ask about military/government discounts (NAWS China Lake), bundling, and low-mileage discounts.

Reliability

Rating: Average (3/5)

Average for this year: the 2006-2009 1.8L Civic can crack its engine block (coolant loss/overheating), usually fixed long ago if it happened. Low miles for the age and one owner help.

NHTSA data for this model year: 7 recalls · 916 owner complaints (62 involving a crash). Most complaints: Air Bags (177), Engine (156), Visibility (112), Suspension (99), Structure (85), Engine And Engine Cooling (55).

Known issues for this model

• Cracked engine block (1.8L R18, 2006-09) - check coolant carefully

• Peeling clear coat in sun

• Rear tire wear (suspension geometry)

• Takata airbag recalls

Check on this car before buying

• Coolant level and any crust near the block/thermostat; ask if the block was ever replaced

• Run VIN: Takata airbag recalls done?

• A/C cold

• Smooth shifts (5-speed automatic)

• Ask for the smog certificate

Vetting checklist (0/12 done)

[ ] Checked KBB/Edmunds fair price

[ ] Recalls checked / completed

[ ] Clean title in seller's name

[ ] Test drive incl. highway & hills

[ ] No overheating; coolant clean

[ ] Pre-purchase inspection

[ ] VIN decoded & matches listing

[ ] History report (Carfax/AutoCheck/NMVTIS)

[ ] Valid smog cert (< 90 days)

[ ] A/C cold after 15+ min

[ ] Tires OK (tread, dry-rot, DOT date)

[ ] Written out-the-door price

All costs and insurance figures are estimates for planning, not quotes. Confirm fees with the CA DMV, rates with insurers, and the car's condition with an independent pre-purchase inspection.